

HER BOOK

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Mary Elizabeth (Kittel) Goodman
(1891-1990)

An autobiographical synopsis by a Woodworth, ND
area pioneer and rural school teacher.

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Gordon Ashley, circa the late 1970s or early 1980s.

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OoO

One of the frustrations of trying to capture a life on paper is to decide where and how to include pieces of information that are totally unrelated to all other pieces of information.

OoO

I, Mary Elizabeth Kittel Goodman, was born December 24, 1891, in Edmunds County, South Dakota. I have often wished that I had asked my mother what time of day I was born but Tena thinks it was toward evening. I don't think my mother had even a neighbor woman with her as I remember her saying she sat up on the edge of the bed on the third day to wash out diapers. I had three brothers, John Charles, George Edward and William Henry, and two sisters, Christina Magdalena and Emma Caroline. Tena is nearly four years older than I and Emma, three years younger, died at the age of six months.

My father, John Kittel, was raised near Quincy, Ill. After the fashion of young men, he went West in harvest time and met my mother, Elizabeth Schellhammer, near Eyota, Minn. She was born at Zoar, Ohio, but they had moved to Minnesota while she was very young and to her last days, she considered Minnesota synonymous with Heaven and disliked Dakota. They were married April 20, 1881. My father went to South Dakota to homestead in the vicinity of Aberdeen. Later, she came to join him. The railroad extended only as far as Watertown at that time. They set up housekeeping in a small sod house with a brush roof which caught fire one windy day about six weeks later and they lost all their possessions--all her 'furnishings', pretty handmade quilts, dried fruit she had brought along, etc. It was a hard blow.

As the boys and Tena were born, they moved from place to place--Columbia, Ordway, Groton are names I remember hearing mentioned--taking tree claims, exemptions, etc., as available. I don't know why they moved to Edmunds County; it may have been because my father had a half-brother there. Adam Kittel had a large family. In the spring after I was born, they moved back to Brown County and settled on the Vincent place five miles north of Westport (17 miles north of Aberdeen). My very earliest memory is of carrying Emma back and forth from one parent to the other. My mother was ill in the hospital for awhile and Tena remembers when Emma died and hearing father building the coffin in the kitchen.

After awhile we moved across the road (and railroad) to the Cobb place. The house was joined to a rude shed called the well-house and my

next memory is of being on a horse with a harness on, which was running toward the barn which had a very low door. How I came to be on this horse or how I got off, I do not know.

We were always hard up but had the necessities of life. I remember sitting in the middle of the floor with a bag of hazelnuts which some men had given me and a queer feeling that something was wrong. I think that at that time we had had to accept help from the county—the equivalent of 'welfare' but at that time it was considered disgraceful to be on the county; and was a last resort before starving.

Fred and Jimmy Vincent were our closest neighbors. Mother baked bread for them—Jimmy was trying to learn to speak German and would say 'Ich hapt nicht brod' when he came for the bread. My folks talked German all the time at first. Charlie learned German before he did English and said it was a help to him in his business later. After he started to school and we moved into English speaking neighborhoods, they talked English at home and I never learned to speak German and understand very little of it. When I started to school we had Vaughns, Stoddards, Tookers and Grantzs for neighbors. I went home with Alice Grantz one Thursday evening to spend the night. Friday was too stormy for school and by Saturday I was so homesick Mr. Grantz took me home to get rid of me. Home never looked so good!

When Tena was a baby, the family had spent part of the winter in Minnesota and mother looked forward to doing it again but finances forbade and my father told me once that from that time on she was a different

woman—she had a jealous disposition and was always accusing my father, without any reason as far as I know, of being interested in other women. This led to many stormy scenes after which she would not speak for days which made our home life anything but pleasant.

We lived on the Cobb place till 1902 when the homestead law allowed my father to take a homestead again and he found a place to file on 14 miles west of Pingree—NW $\frac{1}{4}$ of 14-143-67. This was next to the Amenia Sheep Ranch—a very big deal and they did not exactly welcome us. We packed up everything we owned and put it on or in three wagons. The cattle were driven along behind the wagons and soon separated into two groups—the smaller ones bringing up the rear. My youngest brother, Bill, my sister or I and sometimes all three of us followed the cattle. Charlie was employed in South Dakota, having finished the eighth grade and did not come with us. We camped along the road wherever possible, milked the cows and set up a tent and a corral nights. I do not remember too much about the trip until we got to Buchanan. We had some troubles of course—a broken wagon wheel near Monango, etc. We ate dinner at Buchanan and as we had not found water along the road, father told Bill, Tena and me to go on with the cattle till we found a place where they could drink and then wait for the wagons. It must have been a dry fall as we went over half way to Pingree before we found a ditch with water in it. The cattle drank and laid down—glad to rest. We had one pony along. We waited and waited some more but no wagons came so Tena got on the pony and rode back to find out what was wrong. It started to drizzle and Bill and I crawled into a

culvert under the railroad track and went to sleep. It was after dark when the wagons arrived. Mother had driven too close to a telegraph pole and more or less wrecked her wagon--it took a long time to make it usable again. We spent the night there and the next day made it to the Epp place.

Epps and two families of Heiberts lived close to where Vashti was. My father had got acquainted with them while looking for his homestead and they turned out to be good friends. Epps lived in a sod house but it had a shingled roof and was plastered inside and out so you hardly knew it was sod. This was later Lee Dodge's place--and where Chester Marlow lived and died. Henry Heiberts had a long wooden house which was divided in the center lengthwise and was a barn on one side and they lived in the other side. This building was kept very clean and was a pleasant home. These families were Mennonites and took turns having services in their homes Sundays. We sometimes worshipped with them. They each had a large family--some almost grown-up. I don't remember so much about the other Deitrech Heibert family except we saw the children in school which was then one-half mile north of the Vashti school. There was a DeFehr family in this small community, too. They had their house dug into the side of a hill and claimed to hear strange noises in the hill, sometimes. About the only thing I remember clearly about the DeFehrs took place during a school program. I replaced Tena as the teacher in a skit--I think Tena had gone to work somewhere. This DeFehr boy was supposed to say "My dad will put you in prison if you do that!" But the night we put the program on, he said "My dad will knock the socks off of you!" Nearly brought the house down--including me!

We finished our long move on the next day, September 2, which was on a Sunday. Tena and I rode around looking the place over--visited the slough across the section line west of the site where we built our place. We had a well at one side of that slough the first year or two. Being already September when we arrived there was much to do to prepare for winter. We lived in the tent while the men hurriedly put up hay. The ranch had disregarded the 'No Trespass' signs and made hay on our land where they pleased but allowed us to cut hay where we could on their land rather than let us take their stacks. One slough southeast of the house had been mown early and was green again--it was always known to us as the 'Green Slough'.

Our tent was still standing but we were living in the two-story house we had built with a roof of curved boards, when the first three-day blizzard struck. Father had gone to Pingree, taking us along as far as school. By the time he should have returned, it was impossible to travel. Our teacher, Mrs. Titman, had a small child at home--her husband came early in the afternoon and got her. We couldn't do anything but wait--a little later Mr. Heibert came and took everybody that was left home with him. Mr. Hunt came to Heiberts later to get Ralph, Archie and Helen--this quite awhile before Al was born. We stayed at Heiberts till the storm let up. When it began to storm mother went to our neighbor Kuhls, so there was no one home for at least two days. Father had stayed at Frank Brown's, about a mile east of Vashti. The tent blew away--we found some of the things we had stored in it in the creek southeast of Muellers the next spring.

The Amenla Ranch ran eight bands of sheep of 2000 each at that time.

Louis Kuhl was northeast of us. All the sheepherders had homesteaded for the ranch in the early days. Andrew Nixon was two miles south and Henry Stensland was west of him--I wonder if Johnny Bradfjord wasn't one of their men--I'm not sure. They brought their bands in to the headquarter buildings for lambing and shearing--there were three long sheds on the ranch, a horse barn, the foreman's cook-shack and the bosses' house. I will never forget the unearthly lot of noise those sheep made when they went by our place, especially after shearing when the lambs didn't know their mothers and ran away from them and the ewes trying to own them. The first winter both George and Bill stayed home and went to school but neither of them liked school and worked out the second year--part of the time at the ranch. Bolinger was the boss and Blanchard Pattison the foreman. Mrs. Pattison was cook and they lived in two rooms at the end of the cook-shack. Both the cook-shack and the house had outside stairways. An everflowing spring was the reason the buildings had been located there--the section line ran between the house and barns but there was no public road there at the time. Edmunds was their station as it was several miles closer. At first we went to Pingree but later changed to Edmunds.

To hark back to our life in South Dakota, we attended camp meetings, church services in the Town Hall which was in the country not far from us--there was a cemetery beside it and little Emma was buried there. Years after we went to North Dakota, mother got a letter from the cemetery association asking permission to move her grave. She wrote back, giving it and asking to know the location of the new grave but never heard it. These

meetings were about all our social life—we sometimes went to visit a family named Adams—had a family picture taken at their house in 1898 or thereabouts—I can barely remember it—the doll I was holding was borrowed. Tena and I played with cats instead of dolls. Once Aunt Tena who lived in Kansas sent us a stuffed cloth cat—we played with it till the boys hid it to tease us and couldn't get it back. In 1901, mother's parents celebrated their golden wedding—Tena and I went along and thereby met them. Uncle Jake, Uncle Charlie who lived with the old folks, his wife Cora and a baby, Elsie. Aunt Carrie lived a little way away—we visited her. I had looked forward to having all the apples I wanted in Minnesota but didn't get any. It may have been a poor year for apples. The trip home was uneventful. One summer we had a crock of crabapple pickles in the cellar. Tena and I used to go down and sneak out a few—we could lift them out by the stems and were very tasty. Mother had quite a talent for making what food we have appetizing. She used the sweet vinegar left from the pickles in gravy. We called it sour gravy and liked it. I have never eaten it anywhere else. Egg dumplings cooked in water and fried in butter, and 'Sturum', an egg pancake, cut up was a favorite, too. She steamed crusts and sprinkled them with sugar and cinnamon—'Sweetbread'. Cottage cheese pie was a great favorite—once we were to have it for Sunday dinner but when we came home from services, the empty pan was on the table. Tramps, men who walked the railroad presumably looking for work, were very common and often came to ask for a handout, which they usually got. Peddlers, too, were always coming and going. Some walked, carrying satchels which contained an un-

believable amount of odds and ends--laces, toys, knives, needles and pins, scarves, ribbons, etc., etc. Some of the women stayed overnight and paid for their lodging in goods. We made friends with the railroad men, too. During the Spanish-American War, father and the neighbors arranged to have a roll of daily papers thrown off the train at our place and the boys rode around delivering them. I can remember some old man shouting 'Remember the Maine' and later how excited everyone was when McKinley was assassinated. Tena and I got in the habit of waving at the trains--Chicago, Milwaukee and St. Paul railroad. Our house was quite close to the track and the trainmen began throwing candy and gum off for us--a great treat. One year, Fred Vincent planted a large patch of onions and hired us girls to keep them weeded. At first, we didn't mind it but it got terribly tiresome and we wanted to quit but were not allowed to--never got anything for it, either. I think Fred included our 'wages' in some other deal with father.

In North Dakota, it was several years before a pasture fence was put up and meantime we had to herd the cows. This got to be terribly boring, too. After we got to know the ranch men, they brought us motherless lambs to try to raise--we got quite a flock together and just when they were beginning to be worth something we allowed ourselves to be talked into trading them for a horse--Bill Gray we called him as we already had a Billy Buckskin. The horses we brought from South Dakota were Maggie and Jim, a large team, Blind Maggie, a white horse named Rose which I rode quite a bit, a pony, Nell, who was very hard to catch if she ever got loose, and a colt, Cleve--there must have been a couple more as we had three wagons,

but I don't remember them. The barn was a dugout in the side of a hill. We had a Sharples cream separator in the cellar. Prof. Drache asked me if we used candles—I'm sure we never did but we sometimes used 'lard (grease) lamps'—a wick burning in a saucer of lard—a very poor light but better than none.

When father homesteaded in Section 14, there was a quarter left open on Section 10 and Charlie filed on it to hold it for George till he was old enough to take it. After a few years, the Amenia sheep ranch closed down and the place was taken over by Cravaths. There was an old couple, a young married couple, Llewellyn and Louise, and an older brother, Milo, and a sister, Grace. I worked on the ranch at times. One year, Milo and a hired man called Jean were fencing on Brush Hill when a small thunderstorm went over. A couple hours later, Milo came walking home. Lightning had struck the horses killing them both and ran up the lines to Jean who was driving and killed him. Milo was knocked out of the wagon and badly shocked. Jean was buried in a Catholic cemetery in Carrington. There was some sort of a land promotion scheme carried on with the ranch land—many people came but few stayed. That was how Bud Smith located in the country. Also while I was at the ranch, Uncle Adam came to visit. He was on his way to Canada to visit his brother Will who lived there. Tena still hears from some of the cousins. Lell and Louise were kind to me and I learned a lot there. I was very green and shy in those days.

At school we had a man teacher one year, Waldo Lovett—also Bertha Thompson, who married Bill Rosemore, and Ethel Barlow. I had been working

at G. M. Smith's for several summers and then worked for my board there one winter to finish the eighth grade. Miss Barlow was one of the teachers there and a very good one. Miss Kenny taught the other room and I substituted for her several times. Mrs. Smith was a nice lady and we got along fine. Their son Will was the only one of their family still at home--Karl lived in Carrington, Ernest was a drifter, Georgie married Tom Pendray and Mintie was Mrs. Bowe for awhile. Her husband was a railroad man and got to playing games--she divorced him. We had their little girl, Dudie, for awhile.

Chester Luck, George Woodward, Ray and Roy Boyd, Cora Porteous, Mary Olson (later called Bekken) were some of my classmates. Miss Barlow later married Oscar Bekken--she was the only one I knew here at Gardenette when I moved in. She had suffered a broken hip some years before and was in pain most of the time. She and Mrs. Lusk were buried the same day last year. I attended their funerals. I had known Mrs. Lusk slightly--they had a store and postoffice in Edmunds at one time and we got to be good friends here.

(June 1908) While I was at Smiths the folks told me that father had left the country. He and mother had never got along very good and he decided to go and visit his sister in Kansas. Later he went to Florida and spent the rest of his life there. He left word that Tena should file on the homestead as he had not proved up. She went to Fargo in April 1909 and did this so was in control at home as George had his own homestead, but was at home most of the time.

After I finished the eighth grade, Tena lent me some money and I went to Valley City to attend Normal School for two terms. I was 17 in December, took the teacher's exam in the spring and taught a three month term at McHenry. I went there on the train and got along all right till some of my pupils were quarantined for scarlet fever--this made the school so small it was closed for the duration of the fever and I went to help at the house of the sick--no one else took the disease and I finished the term. Tena and Lena Heibert drove over to get me. On the way home we ran into a windstorm at Kensal--several railroad cars were blown off the tracks. We got home in fine shape. That fall I started to teach the Rudnick school--1910-1911. I boarded at the Kulinks. They were Catholic like everyone else in the neighborhood. Mrs. Kulink could not talk English. Everyone spoke to me in the third person--does teacher want this, etc. It was very lonesome. We went to church at Fried Sundays. They took their eggs, butter, etc., along and did their weekly shopping before services, then after church quite often went to neighbors where the men drank and played cards and the women sat around. In the evening they often had dances which I refused to attend as I said I did not like to dance on Sunday.

Pearl Vincent had come from South Dakota to visit the family, especially Bill, and they wrote of the good times they were having at home. I got so lonesome and homesick we fixed up a scheme where Tena would substitute for me for a week. We were to meet at Edmunds at a dance hall on Saturday evening. Then the boys would take Tena to my school and I would go home. Mr. Kulink took me to Buchanan and saw me get on the train. Mr.

Keyes and the teacher of the Vashti school were on the train. By the time we got to Edmunds it was storming badly and the train got stuck just south of the station. Mr. Keyes said that my folks surely wouldn't come to a dance on such a night and invited me to go home with them. Ben Heibert drove their rig down to the train and we got in the sled and went home. The folks came to the dance after-all and couldn't imagine what had become of me--decided to go to Fried--and there Mr. Kulink said he'd seen me get on the train--such a mix-up. I had my week at home, anyway. The Neva children missed a good deal of school and didn't know of this deal. Tena said they simply stared at her all day--wondering what had happened! When the last day finally arrived quite a few of the mothers came and said they thought I had done a good job. Tena came after me. Mother came along and on the way home we ran into a violent thunderstorm and took shelter at Ole Shano's. Tena and George did a lot of driving for me--taking me here and there.

During the summer, mother's parents became ill and she wanted to go to Minnesota to help care for them. So I gave her the money for her fare and she left for several months. She must have gone in late summer as I remember what a time Tena and I had cooking for threshers. There were many bachelor homesteaders around and they all wanted us to cook for their threshers, too. We were so tired of it--one morning they said that would positively be the last day. But about the middle of the forenoon the next day someone came to tell us they would be there for dinner. I'm afraid they got a very poor meal that time as we were all 'cooked out'.

Tena and Jim Knutson had started going together and decided to be married December 7, 1910. Jim asked a man named John Jellen to be his best man and I went with Tena. We had pictures taken after the wedding and the newlyweds left on a wedding trip to Wisconsin, where Jim's folks lived. On the way home, Jellen proposed to me and was turned down. Mother came home about Christmas time, I think. Her parents had both passed away. When Knutsons came back they lived on the old place and mother and I moved in with George who had built a house on his claim in addition to his 'shack'. The livestock and machinery was divided between Tena and George. I had not taken a school the fall of 1910 as we were so busy but after Christmas mother and I paid a visit at the Jud Hunt home and while there some of the school board at Pingree called Hunts and asked me to finish a term at the Gaffney school south of Pingree. The teacher was from Wisconsin, had gone home for the Christmas vacation and not returned. I accepted the job and George took me to Pingree where I stayed with the G. M. Smiths until Mr. Gaffney took me to the school. I stayed at Gaffneys (Glinz place now) and was 'educated' in many ways. Molly, an elder daughter, was still home, Leo, who much later married Julia McCarthy; Frank and Kate were more my age. They were attending high school. We had been more or less together in the school at Pingree. They had other married children. Among the hired men, Frank Cyewski was quite permanent and often took me to school on cold days. We rode horses and he took my horse back. I played cards with them, went visiting, had my first automobile ride there. I'd seen a car in South Dakota, but had never ridden in one. They were a rough

and tumble group in lots of ways but I enjoyed my stay there. Pete was known as 'Moonlight'—they said he ran his threshing machine that way. Mrs. Gaffney was a pleasant lady. Long afterward when Merna was a baby, I met her in Seaborn's store and she said Merna was so cute—her hair was inclined to curl a little, then; Merna frowned at her in a cute way she had, and Mrs. Gaffney laughed and laughed—said she never knew a baby could do that. They had a house in Pingree and we often spent Saturday and Sunday there. One week I borrowed a horse and rode home Friday night and back Monday morning. When school was over, Tena came after me as usual. That was the last of her long drives for me—after that I taught nearer home.

In September, Charlie married Mary Irene Woods and they came to spend part of their honeymoon with us. I met them in Edmunds with a small rig. They had a trunk along. Chris Wingire was in Edmunds that day and brought the trunk out to George's place—very neighborly. We fixed the upstairs for them—it was unfinished—I realize now it must have been a shock to Irene to see how we lived but she took it like a trooper and we had a good time while they were there. We had plenty of cream which Charlie loved—he ate lots of what he called slushy pie—bread with lots of cream—and when they left he had difficulty buttoning his collar. He swore—said if he had to gain he didn't know why it had to settle there! They went to Lemmon, S. Dak., where he was employed by Brown Bros., a land firm. He mentioned his knowledge of German, learned as a child, was a great help to him in dealing with the farmers in that area. Irene wrote such nice letters.

Though we never saw very much of each other, I loved her and still miss hearing from her. Charlie wrote a Christmas letter to each of us in later years. That was nice, too. They moved to Ritzville, Wash., after a few years and lived there the rest of their lives. They had four boys, Charles, Rodney, Howard and Dale.

When Tena took over the farm she had the roof of the house remodeled into a shingled roof. Rhinehart Mueller and Martin Budra, neighbors, did the work. When we youngsters slept upstairs, it was common to find the quilts near our faces frozen and maybe snow had drifted in on the bed if it had been very windy. We burned hay both for heat and cooking the first years. It was a job to keep the fires going and we weren't overheated downstairs either. Getting the hay into the house on windy days was a job in itself but we couldn't afford coal even if we had had time to haul it 14 miles. Mother raised a large garden and took vegetables to Pingree to sell. One time she ran short of money to pay her grocery bill and had to charge four cents. They mailed duns for it several times before she got around to pay it. Boyd and Mares had a grocery store--Price's, too. Lizzie Price was postmistress--she had sisters and brothers--Tom, Jim, George.

Father really tried to make a go of it. In South Dakota, he and the boys--all quite young then--took a grading job, doing it with horses and scrapers, of course; at the same time we had a bunch of cows to milk, taken on shares--17, I think it was, and it was a job to get them milked. Bill came home nights to help but was always so tired he couldn't do much. In North Dakota, father once rented a farm near Pingree to raise

a crop on. George did the work and batched mostly—once I kept house for him a few weeks—walked to Pingree to get our groceries.

Robert Keith Knutson was born October 25, 1911. I had gotten the Leyman school to teach—Chris Wingire was director. Not long before this, Jim had complained of one of his horses, Frank, not being a good worker. On an impulse, I said: "I'll trade you Billy Gray for him." He took me up right away. Frank was a rangy black horse and I liked to ride him. One day I took a notion to drive him single to school. Coming home, he ran away with me; I was thrown out of the buggy—came to once laying there and mother was standing near me—next thing I knew I was in bed at George's place and they had sent for a Carrington doctor. He actually came down across the hills—no roads to speak of and landed at Henry Leyman's place. Henry could hardly believe he was needed but brought him over to George's and he gave me chloroform—I remember his saying "breathe now", and set my hip which had been thrown out of joint. I was back at work in two weeks. I was very fortunate as the only result from the mishap is that I can't sleep on my right side, even yet, for more than a half hour. The horse, Frank, ran on home and into the side of the straw barn hard enough to injure himself so that he died before I was around again. My mother had just returned from helping take care of Tena and Bobby. Tena had a hard labor—Dr. Van de Eave from Pingree attended her. She had a lady named Inger Bye there also but they wanted mother there as they were both inexperienced with babies.

By this time the Amenias Ranch had been sold and resold and was no

longer a large holding. Many people lived in the buildings, among them the Dirks family which consisted mostly of girls. Lizzie Dirks and I became friends and one summer I went to White Tail, Mont., with the family who were going to start over there. I filed on a claim and decided to go back in the fall, take the teacher's exam in Plentywood and teach there. The country was still very unorganized and when I applied for a school near my claim, the Superintendent of Schools said I could have the school 'if it existed'. I had been going with Walter Goodman for sometime and when I was about ready to take off for Montana again, he asked me to marry him. I accepted the proposal but decided to go on with my plans to teach in Montana. When I got back to Dirks' I found there had been a bad windstorm in the vicinity and my claim-shack which I had hired Ted to build had blown away. So, I gave up the idea of teaching out there, though I had my certificate and returned to teaching the Leyman school. We had begun to have 'literaries' and dances in the school every two weeks and they were very popular—people came for many miles away as so little entertainment was available to us. The Graves boys, Grant and Lilly Ova, the Siebolts and many others beside the patrons of the school were quite regular attendants. A school had been organized at the cook-shack on the former Amenias Ranch and the teacher of that school helped with the programs. Tressie Ingberg was the first to teach there—then Lizzie Dirks—Lizzie, Kate and Mary Dirks were already in circulation and a pair of twins known as Feen and Geen (Josephine and Regina) were coming along. Mary and Kate were involved with Clarence and Henry Graves for awhile and Lizzie

with George Forman who once gave us a wild ride from an Edmunds dance to a Melville dance. Of course, everyone drove horses in these days but we went to dances many miles away. We had good driving teams and buggies. George and I often went to dances at Charly Siebolt's place near the county line.

When I came home from Montana on the Soo train, it had been arranged that Walter was to meet me at Carrington. There was some sort of Fair going on and many people in town. Walter did not meet me--the first time he let me down, but not the last, by a long ways. It turned out he was involved with a group of young men and didn't care to break away. I met Andrew Tow eventually and he took me home. The next evening there was a dance in the new part of the house Wingires were building and Walter came for me and we went on as before. All the way through our marriage this was a weak point and a sore spot--that I could never absolutely depend on him to keep his word to me--to be there when I needed him.

He gave me the lavalier for Christmas that year and a watch the next year. We decided tentatively to be married in December 1914 but Mr. Kavanaugh came to see me and begged me to take the ranch school as they had not been able to get another teacher. We talked it over and decided I should teach till after Christmas and then we'd have money enough to take a wedding trip to Ohio. Tena took over the school the last of January and Walter and I were married in Jamestown at the Methodist parsonage on February 4, 1915. Ole Johnson and Alma Bah were our attendants. I chose Rev. Anderson to marry us because I had heard him preach in Valley City

while at the Normal. We had rooms at the Capitol Hotel and walked from there to the parsonage. Alma and I have laughed about it since--what a sight we must have been walking in our long white dresses in February. It never once occurred to us to take a cab--we were not used to such refinements. Walter and I took the train to Ohio that evening and spent a month there with his folks. I felt cold the first few days--the air was damp compared to North Dakota. The Goodmans thought this comical--anyone from North Dakota thinking it was cold in Ohio! They have always believed North Dakota and the North Pole to be synonymous in temperature. Minnie was near my age and we got to be friends. Ruby, Ralph and Donald were younger. We had good times--the boys took me out in the woods and got me turned around--they thought that was great fun. Walter went to an auction sale and bought an eight gallon cream can full of apple butter, which we shipped. The Goodmans gave us a lot of food which would keep, blankets and odds and ends--packed a big box which we could send as a trunk or baggage.

Before we were married the neighbors had given us a shower so we had lots of things to set up housekeeping with. We stayed at Wingire's a few weeks while we were fixing up a small house near the spring--then moved in. We had all been eating apple butter to our heart's content but finally got tired of it and sold the can and the gallon or so remaining in it to Henry Leyman. He and Emanuel were both old friends of Wingires and came from the same part of Ohio. Henry had a claim just north of the schoolhouse and Emanuel's was farther west. Henry's place is the Martin Hill place now. Joe Blackburn had the claim where Higgins now live. All three were bachelors

till Joe married a Mrs. Bergraff, a widow with four boys—Mrs. Levi Fair's sister. Henry married Bertha Siebolt but Emanuel never married. After he proved up on his claim, he started a grocery store in Woodworth which had grown up in 1911 after the Pingree-Wilton railroad was built. Henry and Bertha lived on his homestead many years--had four children, Leona, Clarence, Raymond and Elinor. They moved to a farm east of Edmunds. We visited them there once and went to the Arrowwood Refuge for a look. Henry and Bertha eventually split up—she had delusions about having second sight and being an artist. Henry went to California, died there of a fall. Blanche and Irvin Hagen were buying some land from him and Clarence tried to beat them out of it, but they got it.

The Blackburn boys, as they were known, were good scholars; John, Edward, Henry and Irvin. Henry and Ruth Wingire were the same age—my primary class that year. Mildred and Ruth stayed with Henry during the coldest weather. The Blackburn house burned down after a gasoline stove exploded, Joe built a new house on the property and then went through bankruptcy. The family left not long after. All six Schilling children attended my school, also Lesters, Kuderlings, Willeys, Lola Parker.

Married women did not teach in those years so I had to quit.

Alma Bah and Donald (Bud) Yule were married in June. They went to Minnesota to Alma's home to get married.

Elizabeth was born on February 23, 1916. Joe Blackburn was staying at Wingire's that night and went and got my mother to help care for me. Dr. Melzer came out as doctors did in those days. Women stayed in bed 10

days. We moved back to our little house and soon after Elizabeth was a year old, I was pregnant again.

Dr. Melzer was away when Merna was born--a tiny baby in the water-bag. She was born late in the evening of a very hot day. I was getting ready to go to a benefit dance for Ray Schilling at George Andersons', when I got sick. A midwife was sent for but she wouldn't leave home till after sunset on Saturday and arrived just in time to save Merna's life. Aunt Mary Wingire was with me during both births--she was always an angel to me. We got Gina Johnson to work for us for a couple weeks. Tena's Gordon had been born January 2. Merna was born on July 28 and when Tena first saw her she said "I'm afraid to touch her for fear she'll break." I've always thought she was a seven-month baby as she slept a great deal the first two months and was so very small--not an ounce of fat on her, just skin and bone. I made her a Hardanger cap while I was in bed--all the baby clothes were so much too big for her. I kept this cap till after she was married and then gave it to her. It got lost during one of their moves.

The year Elizabeth was born there was a regular spate of babies in the neighborhood. Hub and Josie Yule had been married 13 years. They had their first baby, Norman, in October. Alfred Struxnesses had Helga in November, Wingires had Donald in December, Gunder Johnsons had Hilda in January, Elizabeth was born in February, Esther Hanson in March and Pauline Steoring and Maxine Yule during the summer.

Late in the fall of 1917 we moved to the Steoring place as they went

to Minnesota. Alice was born there March 17, 1919. She was a big baby and Dr. Melzer said I was going to have a boy this time. The summer she was small, I had a plague of boils--started with one on my shoulderblade, then a felon (was it a job to manage safety pins!)--then an abcess in my throat that Dr. Melzer lanced, then a couple boils on my knee in threshing time when I had to milk the cows. It ended up with a ring-around--matter came out at the base of my fingernail for six weeks or so. Since that I've hardly had a boil.

In 1918, we lost a beautiful crop in a terrible hailstorm. Grain was beaten into the ground so we didn't even have straw on July 31. The windows of the house were broken on the north side which created such a draft the big south window went out. You could see the dents in the siding on the house made by the hailstones. Walter went threshing that fall to get some money to live on. In 1919 the crop looked good again but didn't fill--most of it wasn't worth cutting. Stotzels moved onto the Northwest Ranch. Lucy could not believe 'that pretty crop' was no good. They had lost out in the Badlands on their claim there. Ernest, Louis and Martha--Herman was born later. Martha and Merna were classmates all through the grades. Alice was a baby then--Lucy fairly drooled over her--"such a good baby, goes to sleep in the highchair instead of crying."

In the fall of 1920, we rented the Tucker place and moved there. It was a most inconvenient house but Mr. Tucker rebuilt it while we were there. We lived in a cook-car while that was going on and the girls all had whooping cough there. They moved the barn and house both--all sorts of

hired men to cook for. Mr. Tucker was there most of the time. He sometimes drove Maude in a single buggy to Courtenay where he had lived most of his life.

George Tucker had quite a tragic life. His father died when he was 11—of rheumatism acquired by working in ice water up to his waist in the building of the Erie Canal. Mr. Tucker told George he should hire a man to start a dairy and deliver milk in the Pennsylvania community where they lived. George quit school and started the route himself—never missed a delivery for seven years. He then moved his family to North Dakota and took a claim near Courtenay. He married a town lady who gave him one son, Avery. They built a fine house in Courtenay—the boy went to West Point and married the day after he graduated. He and his wife settled in California, where Mrs. Tucker Sr. was living, too. Later George went there too and was there when his son was killed by a stab in the stomach. His wife was accused of killing him but she claimed he did it himself accidentally. I never heard the rights of the case but often think what a blow it must have been to him as that boy was the apple of his eye. George Tucker had been a rich man at one time but his luck changed and he was hard up at the time we knew him.

When Alice was two years old, I put a couple little candles on a small cake for her. Mr. Tucker looked at the cake and then at her and said: "That the best you can do? You should see my birthday cake!" He did not like potatoes, said they were only good to fill you up. I made lots and lots of cottage cheese those years, a favorite food of his.

We bought the Perry Miller place the fall of 1922 but we moved onto the place where we lived for very nearly 40 years the spring of 1923--E $\frac{1}{2}$ NE $\frac{1}{4}$ and N $\frac{1}{2}$ SE $\frac{1}{4}$ of Sec. 30, 143, 67, and let the other place go after farming it for awhile. We eventually paid \$500 for the place--bought it from Better Farms, Inc. Guy Gardner was agent and helped us by accepting yearly payments.

A few years later we could have bought the quarter west of us for \$300 cash. We couldn't raise it and later paid \$1000 for it. When Walter retired, we sold it to Roy for \$15 an acre and now (in 1974) I suppose it is worth about \$100 an acre--changes! (In 1977 over \$200 an acre). How anyone can expect to pay for North Dakota land at that price, I'll never know--can't raise more than one crop a year and not always that, by any means.

Elizabeth had started school from the Tucker place. She was to stay at Wingires when we moved in April and finish the term but Ole A. Johnson was very ill there so we took her along. The house we moved into was a ramshackle affair, about four claim-shacks combined but it had an upstairs in one part and the girls could hardly wait to explore it. Art Steffin had worked for us for some years and moved with us. He was fond of Nora Johnson and was glad of the job of taking Elizabeth to school as that meant going by Johnsons and taking them along. Nora was very good to Elizabeth and helped her to get used to school. Donald Wingire and Norman Yule were her first classmates--one day she wore a romper suit that Grandma Goodman sent from Ohio and the teacher, Helen McManus, remarked she had

three boys in class. After we moved Art and Nora got in the habit of meeting at the Perry Miller place on Sundays and soon after got married.

We had quite a few hired men in the course of the years. Carl and Herman Bailey worked at Wingires at the same time as Walter did. Later when we were on the Steoring place, Herman worked for us. He was lame. One time he drove a high-strung team into the yard hitched to a mower. He dropped the three tugs, then put up the lines, unfastened the neckyoke and turned the horses loose. The horse still attached to the mower by one tug went crazy--wrecked everything nearby before he tore loose, bucked and tore around the yard, then jumped a fence and ran up the road. When he came back he still had the collar on but that was all. Melvin Thompson also worked for us, both on the Tucker place and later. One spring was real late. Mr. Tucker was there and the men were working by the month. They played whist many days. Art, who did not like to play whist, thought he was earning his money. Walter's cousin, Bill Goodman, came out one fall and worked at the Wingire place while we were still there. Mike, a Hungarian, was there that year, too. He poisoned my horse, Sorrel Bill, and later himself. He was buried at Lunde church. After we moved to near Goldwin, Ted Stoppleworth worked for us. He was married to Verannie Ditbenner and she often came to visit him. They were divorced later and she had married three other men since--lives at Cathay now. Her sister, Freida, lives here at Gardenette. Jack Klingman, part-time blacksmith in Goldwin, worked for us many times. Martin Hill and Hiram Morris, also.

The girls went to the Leyman school nearly three miles away. We took

them when possible but they often walked home. Those were hard years—money was scarce. We often drove to Goldwin for the mail. I remember telling the girls they couldn't each have a nickel every time we went to town--they'd have to take turns! Walter's sisters, Minnie and Ruby, sometimes sent a box of clothing they were through with and the girls were largely clothed from them. That was a great day when that box arrived!

Several teachers boarded with us, poor as our accommodations were--Cora Rickford stayed during the coldest times--Maxine Yule, Evelyn Rodhe of Valley City. She and Alice became good friends. She was there when I went to Idaho in 1938. She did a lot of sewing for her family--often went home weekends.

Christine was born in 1926, November 17--Alice was seven years and eight months the day she was born--was in school. Tena was supposed to come to be with me but Christine was born a couple days earlier than she figured so we got Mrs. Trautman. Dr. Melzer arrived after Christine did. Irene and Mrs. Trautman were there most of the time till I was around again. This was still in the time when a woman had to stay in bed 10 days. My bedroom was right off the living room with the heater near the door. One evening I was certain the stove had not been shut off properly and crawled out there to fix it; didn't dare to walk! Our neighbors, the Fred Limesands, had two boys, Lyle and Richard, less than a year apart. She was expecting again when I was carrying Christine and I said to her--if you have another boy, I'll have another girl--and that's the way it turned out, but their baby died during the winter. Christine was sick, too, but Mrs. Trautman made an onion

poultice for her that saved her. Mrs. Trautman was a very good neighbor, helped me many times. They had a large family--the oldest ones were all girls so they worked in the fields and outdoors like men but always wore bonnets and gloves--we were good friends.

Shortly after we moved to near Goldwin, Beaches lost one of their four boys, Philip. He died in the winter and Walter helped bury him. He also helped bury Limesands' baby in January 1927. It was real hard work to dig a grave in Gem Cemetery--Walter helped with many.

Someway we got through the years while the girls grew up; dances at Leyman school or in Goldwin were one means of enjoyment--school programs another. Helmar Bahs were good neighbors and Stotzels, too. Hills moved onto the Henry Leyman place.

As the girls finished the eighth grade we took them to the county graduation exercises at the college. Generally had some car trouble. When Elizabeth graduated, Christine was three or four years old and suddenly got very thirsty during the exercises. When I pointed out Elizabeth on her way up to the platform to get her diploma, she called out, "get me a drink Sissy." When Merna graduated, Martha Stotzel went along--we stayed overnight as the school directors met the next day. The girls had great fun with life in a hotel. I bought my first purse, and an odd lot of tennis shoes from which we got lots of good. Years later, when canvas shoes became high style, Elizabeth said to me, "We wore them because they were cheap and available--now they are top style!"

Goldwin was a promising village at one time--two general stores, a

bank, a pool hall, etc. After the bank closed its doors, a high school was opened there. Elizabeth and Merna attended it. Elizabeth put in her first three years of high school there. In her first year she flunked one subject and was inched out of another by circumstances. The teacher had started too many classes and was forced to drop one—she chose to drop the freshman class in favor of Ruth Hauck and then she flunked in the exam so it was a total loss. Elizabeth worked real hard and made up the credits and graduated with a class in Woodworth. She and LeRoy Deede were the youngest in the class.

When the girls started high school in Woodworth they drove back and forth for awhile. Later we rented a room for them in the Castle. Wilbert Hansons lived there then. They did light housekeeping. the house was very cold. They had a laundry stove for both heat and to cook on. They said in very cold weather, water left boiling on the stove was frozen over when they got back. We generally got them home for weekends when they took food along for the week.

About this time Walter met Rev. Upstad in a road mishap and during the conversation it was arranged that a confirmation class be organized in our neighborhood as there were quite a few girls eligible. So Martha Stotzel, Tracy Hill, Genevieve Bah, Elizabeth, Merna and Alice met for lessons and were confirmed in November, 1932. I have always thought Rev. Upstad deserved great credit for going to this trouble as none of us except Helmar Bahs were members of the church, or attending very often.

In October Alice and Christine were involved in an accident. In the early summer I had bought a cheap pair of overalls for Walter. The first

time he wore them, he helped shoe a horse and the horse somehow tore the overalls from pocket to hem. He had never liked them anyway as they were on the small side, so I sewed up the seam and let Alice wear them. After awhile a thread broke and she put a small safety pin in the seam. Christine had gone home with Nettie to get a haircut and I sent Alice after her on Babe, a tame pony. On the way home, she bucked them off—we found the pin open in the seam--no doubt it pricked Babe and that was why the accident happened. We noticed Christine was in pain but Alice seemed all right. Walter and Jack Klingman were away with the car so I got Nettie to take me and Christine to the doctor. He found her collar bone was broken and set it. When Walter and Jack got home, Alice seemed uneasy and couldn't rest. As she was standing by the table, Jack said, "Put your hands over your head." She tried to and fell sideways. Walter took her to Dr. Melzer who kept her overnight and then decided her liver was injured and she had better go to the hospital; so Forest and Elizabeth took her down. Walter stayed with her. Dr. Melzer had said not to let them operate so Walter told them he wanted Dr. Melzer there if they operated. They finally agreed to wait a day or two. The x-rays showed she had bled internally so much they couldn't tell where the blood came from. They packed her in ice and decided after awhile that an operation would do no good. Elizabeth stayed with her awhile, then I went down as she didn't like to be there. After two weeks and two days she was well enough to go home. She had always been a chunky girl but during this period became very thin. Her arm was hurt some but not enough to bother too much. She gained enough strength to be confirmed with the class in November.

After Elizabeth graduated, Merna still had a year left and joined Maxine and Genevieve in a light housekeeping room at Frank Schillings—where Don Johnsons now live. Maxine was a senior, too, and they enjoyed their school life. If they each had a nickel left at the end of the week and were low on food, they would buy a can of soup—big deal! Shows how short we still were on money, and to point the change when John Yule went to high school a few years later, he ate at the restaurant.

Elizabeth had a red graduation dress—embroidered on the sleeves. Merna's was organdy—Nettie helped me make it. For confirmation, each of the girls had a plain white dress which Nettie also helped us make. Each one dyed or tinted the dresses first to a light color then to a dark one so they got lots of mileage from them. The class had their pictures taken with the class from Lunde church. I gave my copy to the church in Woodworth and it is hung in the basement with nearly all the other classes confirmed there.

The last year the girls went to Goldwin to high school, Alice went to grade school there as Christine had not started school yet, and it saved going both ways. She was in a class of boys who'd never had a girl classmate but got along pretty good. She had to take the eighth grade over and Christine was in the first grade then when they got hurt.

After Elizabeth graduated from high school she took a job herding cattle for Geneva Johnson's family near Pingree. Later, she worked in the restaurant in Woodworth. Merna stayed home. The year 1936 was very dry and hot—there was no hay and, of course, no crop. We had to keep the cattle

in order to live as our income was the cream checks. Vestal Cook found out there was plenty of hay to be put up north of Carrington so he and a hired man, Gust Pieske, Walter and I undertook to put up a field of clover on the Roaldson place east of Barlow. Merna, Alice and Christine stayed home to do the chores. It was so hot it was impossible to work one afternoon and when we did work we drank gallons of water. We drove our teams with the mowers and rakes trailing or loaded up there—took a whole day. That terrible hot day the wheat was cooked so we got to put up 55 acres of that, too. After we'd been up there a couple weeks, I drove a mower and the stacker team—Merna said she'd rather do that than stay home. She and Dick Edwards were going together and Dick and his father were up there, too, so I changed places with her. She and Dick were married October 24 that fall. We hired a truck to bring our hay home and had enough so we could sell some to the State Hospital. The next year there was a little more rain and things improved.

Elizabeth had been working in the Larsons' restaurant in Woodworth and married Lloyd Hanson March 3, 1937. They lived in the Farmers Union building for awhile—had a big wedding dance and got lots of presents—then moved into the Nelson Anderson store building which was empty. They were very comfortable there. Boyd Lee was born June 22, 1938. Merna and Dick lived on the farm and Harvey and Mrs. Edwards moved into town. Winifred Anne was born October 8, 1937—my first grandchild. Alice and I helped Merna the first weeks. A little later Alice got a job as assistant postmaster to Mrs. Uggen. she liked the job and it made quite a change in her life. I have always been

thankful to Mrs. Uggan for giving her the chance. After Alice finished school, Christine stayed with Merna and Dick one winter and went to school there. Ruth Cook had a second girl that fall, Frances, only a month older than Winifred—they have been friends through the years.

In the spring of 1935, Bob Knutson had driven Mrs. Gil Thompson and children to Nampa, Idaho, to visit the oldest girl, Verna. Mrs. Thompson didn't have enough money to return and they waited there several months for Gil to send money. Meantime Bob had worked at different jobs and decided that he'd like to live in Idaho. When they finally returned to North Dakota, he told his folks he was going back there to live. Gordon decided to go along—and Tena said, "Why don't we all go?" They had lost the land she and our father had kept for 14 years and were living in a small house on rented land. They decided to have a sale and leave the first part of November, 1935. They had dinner with Muellers and got stuck on the way out as it had snowed quite a lot. They were pulling a small trailer Bob had built. They went to Wisconsin first as Jim, who was not keen on the move they were making, wanted to see his folks again. They stopped at Rochester to see Uncle Jake Schellhammer, too. From Wisconsin they went straight south to Highway 30 and then straight west to Idaho. While passing through Wyoming, Jim remarked he wouldn't live there if they gave him the whole state. They soon located a cheap lot and built a house at 223 Ivy Street where Tena has lived ever since. Jim worked on PWA and did carpenter work—soon enlarged the house. In 1938, Henry Hauck was planning on going to Oregon City where the rest of the family were and I rode with him to visit

the Knutsons. We were still very hard up--Walter borrowed \$10 or \$20 from Jack McCarthy for me to travel on and after Thanksgiving, sent me part of the turkey money to buy a ticket home. I enjoyed the trip--thought the climate was nice but not worth sacrificing everything for. When the people started saying how cold it was at 30° above, I asked them what about 30° below?

I got home around December 1 and was in town when we thought of it that the Harry Clark 25th wedding anniversary was the next day. Ruth and I decided to make a quick affair of it. We got Walter to announce it at an ASC meeting he was having at the hall. Many men were there. We told everyone to come and bring eats and help Clarks celebrate. Alma Yule said it just couldn't be done that way--you had to plan and tell people what to bring, etc., but it was a very successful affair--lots of people, and plenty to eat. As usual, two men "passed the hat" and let people put in what they wished to for a present to the honored couple. Maggie and Harry were very pleased to be honored in this way.

January 1939 was the coldest month--never went above zero for weeks--the barn frosted over inside and was as warm as the house. Evelyn Rohde was teaching our school that year and boarding with us. She and Alice got to be great friends and still keep in touch. She started the girls to pin up their hair--always was very neat and dressy. Her folks lived near Valley City and she got home weekends sometimes and brought back sewing to do. She and Alice managed the house and Christine very well while I was in Idaho. Evelyn cried when she left us to go home. We went to Rogers to spend the

Fourth with Rohdes and enjoyed the trip except that we stayed for the dance and had to face bright lights all the way to Pingree--after that we did not meet so many cars.

In February, 1940, Alma and Bud sponsored a dance for us on our 25th wedding anniversary. Rohdes came to it and spent the night with us. There was a good crowd at the dance and we got a nice purse as well as many congratulatory good wishes.

In June, Mrs. A. Hanson and I both wished to celebrate Yules' 25th anniversary. We settled it by having two affairs--a dance in the hall Saturday evening which was a big success and a picnic at Yules' place the next day. Both were well attended and enjoyed by many neighbors, relatives and friends.

On June 2, 1940, Merna and Dick had a stillborn son. After a small funeral at their home, he was buried in Gem Cemetery. I took Winifred along and she slept in my arms while her little brother was buried. In September, 1971, Winifred lost a daughter in very similar circumstances. She, too, was buried in Gem Cemetery. Richard Raymond Edwards, Jr., and Ann Marie Higgins.

Sharel Mary Hanson was born on August 31, 1941. By this time, Lloyd and Elizabeth had bought and moved into the former print shop. Boyd stayed with us now and then--Lloyd brought him out when Sharel was born but soon got him home again to see his new sister.

Loren Leighton Edwards was born June 21, 1942.

After a couple years, Lloyd got a job in the Black Hills on a government project, building igloos--shelters for ammunition. He bought a trailer;

Ole and Tillie, Walter and I helped them move into it and they left to live near the job. Lloyd worked nights and slept days so Elizabeth and the children spent a lot of time outdoors and were brown as Indians when they came back to Woodworth. They then bought the farm south of the Bah place. For awhile, they had the farm home, the trailer and the former print shop in town, but soon sold the place in town to Mrs. Uggan. They also sold the trailer and started to improve the farm. Lloyd remodeled the barn and built onto the house. Boyd and Sharel were happy on the farm--especially Sharel as she loved animals and the outdoor life. They had a pony and hitched it to a small sled one winter and drove over to see us. Bob and Esther moved onto the Perry Miller place about this time. Lloyd trained a colt we gave Boyd to go meet the children in the evening to bring them home from school.

Meantime, Alice had married John Kragh and Christine and Roy Hall were married at almost the same time. That was a happy time--Merna on the Edwards place, Elizabeth nearer, Alice lived in the camp south of us and Christine and Roy north of us. We got our mail on the route in a box near Elizabeth's and saw each other often. John Kragh was an older man who ran a crane for Max McCall on the rock-crushing job at Goldwin. He had worked for Max for many years. When Max took on this job at Goldwin he sent John and Swampy from Hector, Minn., to North Dakota with the simple instruction, Turn west at Pingree and stop at the second elevator. He and Swampy thought it the most desolate country they'd ever seen and if anyone had told them they'd both marry local girls and stay there many years, John said, they would have had a good laugh and thought it crazy. But it happened.

Halls had moved to a place a mile east of us and Christine and Roy were engaged when he, Bill and Harlan went into the Army. Roy was stationed at different places in the South during his training and sailed from the West Coast for Iran. They landed at Wellington and were marched out for a few miles then went back on the ship and sailed on--this was the only time they disembarked.

After the war ended, his company was flown home by way of Germany and England to New York so he has been clear around the world. Meantime, Christine had gone to Jamestown for waitress work--was working at the depot lunchroom when he detrained there.

They married soon after--at Clif and Marian Hall Conlin's place in Minnesota. Rhoda was bridesmaid. Alice was married to John Kragh at Moorhead about the same time. I have only attended one of my daughters' weddings--that was Merna and Dick's. I was at both of Winifred's weddings, also Gladys' at Dilworth, Sharel's at Denver, Gloria's at Woodworth, Ray's at Lake Williams, Sheila's at Woodworth and Loren's at Ypsilanti, Mich. I was in Nampa with Tena when Merna called to say there was room for me in the car going from Dilworth to Ypsilanti. I was about ready to come home anyway so I went by bus directly from Nampa to Fargo, Bob picked me up there and the next day, Merna and Dick flew to the wedding and Bob, Winifred, Gladys, Susie, Cindy and I set off by car. We saw much beautiful country, the sands in Michigan, drove through Chicago and arrived safely. We had good accommodations and enjoyed both the trip and the wedding.

When Sharel was married, I was in Jamestown so I took a bus from here

to Denver. Boyd was stationed at Lowry AFB then and met me at the bus depot early in the A.M. Elizabeth and Gordon came by bus from Goldendale, Wash., the groom's parents came from Wisconsin, and the groom from West Point. One of his attendants was attending school in Providence, R. I. We attended the dinner at Holiday Inn before the rehearsal. The wedding day was so warm and nice, Elizabeth and I walked from the hotel to the church without coats. Boyd kept saying, "It isn't always like this in Denver on December 17!" The wedding and reception at the Cherry Creek Inn went off well--was lovely. Sharel had a car; Boyd took that off her hands and Gordon drove Boyd's car back to Washington. I went with them for a visit.

I visited them in Goldendale a number of times--it was very pleasant--the weather was usually good--no snow to speak of. One year when we had a bad winter in Dakota my gas line froze and I was at my wits' end as to what to do. Elizabeth called and said I should spend a couple months with them so I caught a ride to Jamestown with Chauncey Gwynn and went out there. I think that was the winter they had snow that stayed. There were several inches on the ground when I came and it kept coming and kept coming. The Columbia River Gorge was blocked for awhile--which meant no mail. All of Goldendale's freight, mail, etc., came from Portland. In Goldendale the mail was not delivered--everyone had to go to the postoffice after it.

Not long after we got back from Denver one of Gordon's nieces called from Eugene, Ore., and invited them to spend Christmas there. She said they should bring me along and we went and had a very nice time with them. One night, our hostess took us for a drive and we stopped on a high place--

lights everywhere—millions of them, it seemed—beautiful! We spoke of the days in North Dakota when there was no light to be seen unless you were carrying a lantern and marveled how things change.

Usually, before I left Goldendale to go to Idaho, I went to Oregon City to visit Klingmans. The bus went west from Goldendale so I saw that part of Washington—boats, tows and barges on the Columbia and crossed the river at Portland and then on to Oregon City. There seemed to be a feud between the cities as in Portland you couldn't buy a ticket to Oregon City and go on a Greyhound bus so I always bought a round-trip ticket and could get along without changing depots. Klingmans had a nice home built on the side of a hill. The front door was on Willamette Street (there was a lovely holly tree across the street and on clear days you could see Mt. Hood from the front yard) but the hill fell away. We went downstairs inside to the basement where she had a lovely sewing room. She made lovely quilts and things for the Goodwill people. If you went out another door from there and down another short flight of steps you passed the garden and arrived at the barn where the goats and chickens lived.

Mrs. Klingman is a health faddist—we drank alfalfa tea and goats' milk and ate very well. One night I remember she had artichokes which made her brother, Fred Houk, and me sick later—I don't know why as they tasted good.

All the Klingman children lived nearby—though nearly every family had a different address—towns ran into each other. Jessie Hauck and her mother lived in Gladstone—we visited them one day. I visited most of their

homes or they came home to see me. Jack was not very well already then but enjoyed hearing of North Dakota and talking of the old days when he worked for us.

One time I went from Klingmans to visit Henry Hansons—saw Archie Hanson and Cora Schilling while there, also the Swadburgs. Orma took me to Wilbert's place and to Lloyds--Portland's West Acres!

When I went back to Goldendale the bus went on the other side of the Columbia River and I got a good view of the Oregon side—lots of waterfalls coming down the mountainsides—beautiful views and trees. The bus crossed the river at Biggs and so got back to Goldendale. Biggs is a junction where several bus lines cross—once I didn't change buses there when I should have and was taken to Bend, Ore., to spend the night. Sure saw lots of wide-open spaces on the way back in the morning.

About 1960 Walter thought he'd get glasses to fit his eyes—he had been using cheap magnifying ones up to that time. The oculist told him there was something wrong and took him to a doctor who told him he had diabetes and gave him a diet. He tried for a short time to stay on it but then said if he was going to die, he'd rather die of the disease than starve to death. From then on he doctored with Dr. Martin in Medina, took insulin in pill form and grew thinner.

In November 1954 we took a trip west. We visited my brother Charlie, Fred Limesands, Merna and Dick at Pasco. where they were living at that time, then went to Idaho to visit Knutsons and stopped at Salt Lake City to visit Gordon and family. The bus took us across the Mississippi River

at Omaha and we went through Iowa into South Dakota, stayed overnight at Huron and went through Aberdeen, Westport and Frederick where I lived as a child, but didn't see anything familiar as the road had been moved a mile west of our old place. We both enjoyed this trip a lot but then I began to think it was all my folks we have visited and we should visit Walter's folks, too. So the next summer, 1955, one Sunday we attended the anniversary of the church in Pingree where we met Elizabeth and Sharel, who went to Woodworth with us. We had dinner at Edwards, Elizabeth gave me a permanent, we stopped at Roy Hall, Srs., to get in on their 40th wedding anniversary celebration--then Elizabeth picked us up and took us along to Jamestown and we took the bus for Wooster, Ohio. Walter's mother was living with Minnie who was working in a big store. We spent a little over a week there--it was very hot most of the time. We saw all the family and were glad afterward we'd made the trip as Walter's mother passed away the next month--she had wanted to see Walter again. We crossed Lake Michigan on a ferry on the way home--so nice on the water. Soon after we got back we attended the wedding of Winifred and Alvin Zinke.

We sold most of our land to Roy and Christine, keeping an eighty. We lived there quietly. In 1962, Walter spent a week in the hospital--Hiram brought me down to take him home while John Glenn was orbitting the earth. Walter kept on getting thinner and failing till he had a stroke one evening. We got an ambulance to come for him--he was unable to speak plainly or move much. He died the morning of February 18, 1963, and was buried on February 20, a bitterly cold day.

I never lived on the place again. We had a sale in June and sold household goods, machinery, buildings, the car, land, and all. I lived in Woodworth most of the time taking trips west nearly every winter till the spring of 1969 when I moved to Gardenette Drive—a HUD in Jamestown on 13th Street Southeast, and have lived here very comfortably ever since.

It occurs to me the girls might some day wonder what time of day they were born so I will record here that Elizabeth was born shortly after midnight, Merna was born in the evening, Alice in the forenoon and Christine late in the evening.

AFTER-THOUGHTS

1902 or 1903—Our first crop on the homestead was threshed by treadmill. Epps had a small thresh machine powered by two horses on a treadmill. I can remember watching them. In South Dakota, we used a blind horse, Maggie, on a different sort to pump water. She had to go round and round, while Epp's horses were always climbing. We girls were supposed to keep Maggie going and got by pretty easy as she could not see if we were there or not and so kept going most of the time.

1900--We had catalogues from a J. Lynn Co. They specialized in cheap jewelry and it was a great thrill for us to send for some cheap trinket. When Bill was working in South Dakota and came home to visit he brought us gifts. I remember an elaborately beaded pin cushion and a cute box with a celluloid lid. I think Tena still had hers but such things never stayed with me.

I seem to have left out the part about our house burning in 1944. Ralph Norden had come that morning to get Walter to go along to Jamestown to help him get permission to buy a tractor--this was wartime and everything was restricted or impossible to get. Christine was in Jamestown and Merna also, as Winifred was taking treatments from Mrs. Jones--so I went along. When we came back just before dark, the house had burned--we never knew what the fire started from but suspected sparks from the lignite--men were just pushing the west wall into the basement when we arrived. We

stayed at Lloyd Hansons that night and for several days. Then we rented a trailer-house from Chris Wingire and lived in that until we were able to build. Everyone was most kind and brought useful articles as well as donating a large sum (for those days) of money.

HER BOOK

by

Mary Elizabeth (Kittel) Goodman
(1891-1990)

An autobiographical synopsis by a Woodworth, ND
area pioneer and rural school teacher.

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